example, he insisted on ideological integrity and purity—not just in the rank and file, but even in the upper echelons.

Another key unstated purpose of the Yatra was the theme of '*Bharat jodo* (unite India)'. It may seem superfluous to the cynical, but it is wrapped in a deep sense of concern about how our society has been methodically manipulated to reject the spirit of fraternity and empathy for each other. The political ambitions of certain groups have sought to interfere with multiple civilizational strengths of India, whether it be the celebration of unity in diversity, cosmopolitanism or respect for common humanity. The blind pursuit of uniformity that we have witnessed these past few years is a direct threat to the rich diversity of our existence and national experience. And so the Yatra was needed to signal to India's vast diversities that we embrace you all as part of the whole body polity.

But in doing so, the Yatra did not critique, denigrate or hate anyone. 'Hate the sin, not the sinner' has been the Mahatma's eternal message to humanity. The Yatra put this into practice. Eschewing any hatred for those who have imposed regressive ideas on India, the Yatra was a satyagraha to appeal to their soul about their commitment to each other, and thereby reclaim the nation's soul.

Interestingly, I feel that the Yatra unconsciously gave life to the eleven Gandhian principles that were strictly adhered to in every ashram in every aspect (although the new-age facilities of food, accommodation and sanitary arrangements added a modern flavour). One might go so far as to describe the Yatra as a moving ashram that was not adequately portrayed in the extensive media coverage. In fact, even though social media captured many aspects of the Yatra, it could not fully capture the vitality and vibrance of this mobile ashram. One still had to experience it in flesh and blood—the excitement of sharing accommodation in the modified dormitories (which were just truck containers), the intimate act of sharing meals, swapping stories around evening bonfires, the shared songs in the Yatra, the camaraderie in nursing each other and the jokes. This is the sort of feeling one has when a movement is beginning and there is hope for the future. Those of us who have been in politics for decades felt revitalized by